CONCEPT AND PLAYER EXPERIENCE

SKYBOUND

A small adventure above the ground.

01 Title and pitch

SKYBOUND: a mobile platformer in which a tiny hero jumps between platforms, collects every coin and reaches a flag to travel from a bright world into a violet night.

02 Genre and platform

Genre: single-player action platformer with short, replayable levels. Target: Android, landscape. Keyboard and gamepad support remain available for desktop testing. A physical Android build is still to be tested.

03 2D or 3D

2D pixel art. An orthographic camera shows the level from the side. The hero uses frame-based idle, run, jump and fall animations. No 3D characters or rigging are required.

04 Core loop

MOVE / JUMP / COLLECT / FINISH

Explore the ground and raised platforms, collect all 10 coins, then approach the unlocked flag. Level 1 loads Level 2; the final flag shows YOU WIN! A spike hit or fall removes one of three hearts and returns the hero to the start. Zero hearts ends the attempt; Restart begins a fresh run.

05 Controls and interface

Control	Action
Left on-screen joystick	Move left or right. Desktop: A/D or arrow keys.
Round Jump button	Jump while grounded. Desktop: Space.
Pause / Resume	Freeze gameplay, physics and game audio; continue the same attempt.
Restart / Menu	Reset the current level / return to the separate main menu.
Play / Quit	Load Level 1 / close the application. Quit stops Play Mode in the editor.

HUD: three hearts, collected / total coins and Pause. Mobile layout uses a 1920 x 1080 canvas, Match = 1, corner anchors and SafeArea panels. The Jump button is 220 x 220. Other button sizes and small labels still need a final accessibility pass.

SCOPE AND PRODUCTION

06 Content

Implemented: two separate levels; 10 coins, three raised platforms and a finish flag in each; spike and falling hazards; three hearts, one-second immunity with blinking, pause and lose/win screens. Level 2 changes platform positions, uses a night background and gives the hero a violet colour variant.

Planned additions: one patrolling enemy type, local saving of the highest unlocked level and lightweight feedback effects. These features are not implemented yet. The game remains a compact two-level experience.

07 Art and sound

Style: clear pixel silhouettes, readable platforms and a consistent gold interface. Level 1 uses a bright sky palette; Level 2 uses violet terrain and a darker sky. The second skin is a colour variant of the same animated character.

Sources: character, terrain, coins and flag come from the supplied Simple 2D Platformer BE2 project assets. UI uses native Unity uGUI elements and built-in graphics. Ten procedurally synthesized WAV files provide music for the menu and both levels, plus jump, coin, hurt, click, unlock, finish and lose sounds. Audio was created with Codex assistance.

08 MVP for the week-15 build

Required: two completable levels; responsive touch movement and jumping; all-coins finish gates; health and fair restart rules; working menu, HUD, pause and victory flow; balanced music and effects; one simple enemy type; local level-unlock saving. The last two features remain planned.

Acceptance: the game starts at the menu, each level can be completed without external tools, restart resets the attempt, and essential UI stays readable on 16:9, notch phones and 4:3 tablets. Complete at least one physical Android playtest before release.

09 Cut list

No multiplayer, online leaderboard, accounts, shop, paid skins, procedural levels, 3D conversion or additional worlds. No iOS release in this project scope. Keep cosmetic changes limited to existing character colour variants.

10 Plan for weeks 9-13 and ownership

This is an individual project. The student owns programming, level design, art integration, sound, testing and submission. The schedule below is a milestone plan, not a claim that all weeks are complete.

Week	Deliverable	Current state
9	GDD, GitHub setup and three mobile UI screens.	UI implemented; GDD prepared; repository work remains.
10	Finish gates, two-level route and one patrolling enemy.	Levels and gates implemented; enemy planned.
11	Save the highest unlocked level locally; test restart and loading.	Saving planned; scene flow tested in the editor.
12	Balance music and effects; test on an Android device.	Audio implemented; physical-device test remains.
13	Add small VFX, polish touch targets and retest three screen formats.	VFX and final UI pass planned.

Production disclosure: the current implementation was developed with Codex assistance. This GDD describes the design and clearly separates implemented features from future work.